

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 7

Reviewing Experiments & Deepening Cognitive Restructuring *Fictional Educational Example — Full Detailed*

SESSION INFORMATION

Client: RK (35 y/o Male)
Session #: 7 of 16

Therapist: Dr. A.
Focus: Experiments review + Deep cognitive restructuring

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client has been consistent and successful with behavioral experiments. Belief in the old perfectionistic thought is now around 30%. Today we will do a thorough review of experiments, deepen cognitive restructuring using Socratic questioning and the “What would you tell a friend?” technique, and plan the next phase of experiments focused on core fears.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, RK. How has your week been? Let's review the experiments and thought records you brought.

Client: It was a solid week. I did two experiments — one where I shared an idea without over-preparing, and another where I said “no” to an extra task. Both went better than I expected. My belief in the old thought is down to about 30% now.

Therapist: That's excellent progress. Can you walk me through one of the experiments?

Client: In the team meeting, I shared an idea without spending hours preparing backup answers. I felt anxious before, but the discussion went fine. No one questioned my competence. It felt freeing.

Therapist: That's powerful evidence. What did you learn from it?

Client: That I don't need to be perfect to be taken seriously. People still respected my input even when it wasn't over-prepared.

DEEPENING COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING

Therapist: Let's take the old belief “I have to be perfect or they will see I'm not good enough” and look at it more deeply using Socratic questioning.

Therapist: What is the worst that could realistically happen if you made a small mistake in a meeting?

Client: Someone might point it out. I might feel embarrassed for a while.

Therapist: And if that happened, what would that mean about you as a person?

Client: That I'm not as competent as I should be.

Therapist: And if you're not as competent as you “should” be, what does that say about your overall worth?

Client: That I'm not good enough overall.

Therapist: Now let's look at the other side. What evidence from your actual life goes against the idea that one small mistake means you're not good enough?

Client: I've made small mistakes before and still got promoted. My current manager has given me good feedback overall. My wife and friends value me for more than just my work performance.

Therapist: Excellent. If we were to create an even stronger balanced belief based on all this evidence, what would it sound like?

Client: “Making small mistakes is normal and doesn't define my overall competence or worth. I am good enough even when I'm not perfect.”

Therapist: How much do you believe this new statement right now (0–100)?

Client: About 75%. It feels much more true than the old one.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Time / Postponement
2. Practice using the new balanced belief whenever the old one appears and rate your belief daily
3. Do one more behavioral experiment focused on your biggest remaining fear (e.g., making a visible small mistake on purpose in a low-stakes situation)
4. Write down 5 pieces of real-life evidence that support your new belief

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your successful experiments and did deeper Socratic work on your core belief. You came up with a strong new balanced belief. What felt most useful?

Client: The Socratic questioning helped me see the chain of thoughts clearly. And the new belief feels much more balanced and realistic.

Therapist: Great. Any questions?

Client: No, I'm clear.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client continuing to show excellent engagement and insight.
- Strong progress on core belief work (now significantly reduced).
- Behavioral experiments remain highly effective for this client.
- Next session: Review new experiments and evidence, continue cognitive work if needed, begin introducing relapse prevention concepts in preparation for the second half of therapy.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.